

# Day 60 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

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## Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Science & Technology (2): Padma Awards 2026 & Infosys Prize 2025

### READING MATERIAL

*Covers the Padma Awards 2026 (announced on the eve of Republic Day 2026) and the Infosys Prize 2025 — India's major civilian and scientific recognition programmes.*

**Q:** How many total Padma Awards were announced for 2026, and what is the breakdown by category?

**A:** 131 total awards: 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, and 113 Padma Shri — announced on the eve of Republic Day 2026.

**Q:** What were the demographic highlights of the Padma Awards 2026 list?

**A:** 19 women awardees; 6 in the Foreigners/NRI/PIO/OCI category; and 16 posthumous awards.

**Q:** Name two Science & Engineering Padma Shri 2026 awardees and their states.

**A:** A.E. Muthunayagam (Kerala) and Krishnamurty Balasubramanian (Telangana).

**Q:** What is the Infosys Prize, and what does each laureate receive?

**A:** An annual award from the Infosys Science Foundation, given across six categories (Economics, Engineering & Computer Science, Humanities & Social Sciences, Life Sciences, Mathematical Sciences, Physical Sciences). Each winner receives a gold medal, a citation, and USD 100,000.

**Q:** What notable later achievement is associated with past Infosys Prize laureates, illustrating the prize's track record?

**A:** Past laureates have gone on to win the Nobel Prize (e.g., Abhijit Banerjee and Esther Duflo) and the Fields Medal (e.g., Manjul Bhargava and Akshay Venkatesh) — underlining the Infosys Prize's reputation as an early indicator of major international scientific recognition.

### MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

**1.** How many total Padma Awards were announced for 2026?

- A. 95
- B. 112
- C. 131 ✓**
- D. 150

*Explanation:* 131. [medium, web-research]

**2.** How many Padma Vibhushan awards were given in 2026?

- A. 3
- B. 5 ✓**
- C. 8
- D. 13

*Explanation:* 5. [medium, web-research]

**3.** How many Padma Bhushan awards were given in 2026?

- A. 5
- B. 13 ✓**
- C. 20
- D. 30

*Explanation:* 13. [medium, web-research]

**4.** The Padma Awards are announced annually on the eve of:

- A. Independence Day
- B. Republic Day ✓**
- C. Gandhi Jayanti
- D. Constitution Day

*Explanation:* Republic Day. [easy, web-research]

5. The Infosys Prize is awarded across how many categories?

A. Four

B. Five

**C. Six ✓**

D. Eight

*Explanation:* Six. [medium, web-research]

6. What does each Infosys Prize laureate receive?

A. A cash prize only

**B. A gold medal, citation, and USD 100,000 ✓**

C. A government job offer

D. Free laboratory space for life

*Explanation:* Gold medal, citation, and USD 100,000. [medium, web-research]

## Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Puzzles

### READING MATERIAL

*Puzzles is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. The genre overlaps with Logical Reasoning, so this topic focuses on archetypes NOT already covered there: comparison chains, age puzzles, family-relation puzzles, and linear seating arrangements — all extremely common TNPSC puzzle shapes.*

**Q:** Method — comparison chain (not all four compared directly, must chain through clues): D is taller than C but not as tall as B. C is taller than A. Who is the tallest?

**A:** Chain it:  $B > D > C > A$ . So B is the tallest. The key technique: write each clue as an inequality, then merge them into one ordered chain rather than trying to compare all pairs mentally.

**Q:** Method — classic age puzzle: A father is 4 times as old as his son. In 20 years, he will be twice as old as his son. Find their current ages.

**A:** Let son's current age =  $x$ , father =  $4x$ . In 20 years: father =  $4x+20$ , son =  $x+20$ . Condition:  $4x+20 = 2(x+20) \rightarrow 4x+20 = 2x+40 \rightarrow 2x=20 \rightarrow x=10$ . Son is 10, father is 40.

**Q:** Method — family-relation puzzle: Pointing to a photograph, a man says, 'She is the daughter of my mother's only son.' How is the woman in the photo related to the man?

**A:** His daughter. 'My mother's only son' = the man himself (since he's referring to his own mother, and he's an only son). So 'her father' = the man, making the woman his daughter.

**Q:** Method — linear seating arrangement: Five friends P, Q, R, S, T sit in a row. Q is immediately to the right of P. R is at one end. S is between Q and T. T is not adjacent to P. Find the order.

**A:** Work from the most fixed clue first: R is at an end — try R at the left end. P-Q must be adjacent with Q right of P, and S is between Q and T, with T not adjacent to P. Testing R,P,Q,S,T: P-Q adjacent ✓, S between Q&T ✓, T not adjacent to P (T is at position 5, P at position 2, not adjacent) ✓, R at an end ✓. Order: R, P, Q, S, T.

**Q:** Method — distribution/sharing puzzle: A sum of money is divided among A, B, and C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets thrice as much as C. If C gets ₹600, find the total sum.

**A:**  $C=600$ .  $B=3 \times 600=1800$ .  $A=2 \times 1800=3600$ . Total =  $3600+1800+600 = 6000$ .

### MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. P is shorter than Q but taller than R. Q is shorter than S. Who is the tallest?

- A. P
- B. Q
- C. R
- D. S ✓**

*Explanation:* Chain:  $S > Q > P > R$ . S is tallest. [medium, authored]

2. A mother is 3 times as old as her daughter. In 15 years, she will be twice as old as her daughter. Find the daughter's current age.

- A. 10
- B. 12
- C. 15 ✓**
- D. 18

*Explanation:* Daughter= $x$ , mother= $3x$ .  $3x+15=2(x+15) \rightarrow 3x+15=2x+30 \rightarrow x=15$ . [medium, authored]

3. Pointing to a man, a woman says, 'He is the son of my father's only daughter.' If the woman has no siblings, how is the man related to her?

- A. Her son ✓**
- B. Her brother
- C. Her nephew
- D. Her father

*Explanation:* 'My father's only daughter' = the woman herself (she has no siblings). So the man is her son. [medium, authored]

4. ₹7,000 is divided among A, B, C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets twice as much as C. Find C's share.

- A. ₹1,000 ✓**
- B. ₹1,200

C. ₹1,500

D. ₹2,000

*Explanation:* Let  $C=x$ ,  $B=2x$ ,  $A=4x$ .  $\text{Total}=7x=7000 \rightarrow x=1,000$ . [medium, authored]

5. Four friends sit in a row. B is immediately right of A. C is at the left end. D is not adjacent to A. Find the correct order.

**A. C, A, B, D ✓**

B. A, B, C, D

C. C, D, A, B

D. D, A, B, C

*Explanation:* C at left end; A-B adjacent with B right of A; D not adjacent to A. Order C,A,B,D satisfies all three conditions. [medium, authored]

## Part C – General English: Vocabulary: Idioms, Phrases, and Phrasal Verbs

### READING MATERIAL

*Covers common idioms/phrases tested by their MEANING (not just recognition) and phrasal verbs via fill-in-the-blank — exactly the formats real exams use.*

**Q:** Real exam: Fill in these phrasal verbs — "ring her \_\_\_\_" (call), "drop \_\_\_\_" (visit informally), "do \_\_\_\_ it" (manage without), "trying it \_\_\_\_" (testing) — using out/in/up/without.

**A:** Ring her UP (call her). Drop IN (visit casually). Do WITHOUT it (manage without having it). Trying it OUT (testing it) — all four confirmed via a real exam's fill-in-the-blank question using a shared word bank.

**Q:** Real exam: What does the phrase "given to" mean?

**A:** Accustomed to (e.g., 'he is given to exaggeration' = he is accustomed to/has a habit of exaggerating) — confirmed by a real exam question.

**Q:** Real exam: What does the phrase "cast down" mean?

**A:** Dejected (sad, downcast) — confirmed by a real exam question.

**Q:** Real exam: What does the idiom/saying "failures are stepping stones to success" mean, and what does the phrase "reconcile to" mean?

**A:** "Failures are stepping stones to success" means setbacks/failures are necessary steps that lead toward eventual success, not permanent obstacles — confirmed by a real exam question. "Reconcile to" means to ACCEPT (something unwelcome) half-heartedly/reluctantly, not to fully embrace it — also confirmed by a real exam question.

**Q:** Real exam: What does the idiom "beauty lies in the eyes of the beholder" mean?

**A:** What is considered beautiful depends on the individual perceiving it — beauty is subjective, not an objective, universal standard.

**Q:** Real exam: What is the REAL meaning of "to be at large", and of "to pass the buck" — and what is the common trap?

**A:** "To be at large" really means FREE / AT LIBERTY (e.g., a criminal still 'at large' has not been captured). "To pass the buck" really means TO BLAME (someone else) / SHIFT RESPONSIBILITY onto another person. A real exam tested these two idioms with their meanings deliberately SWAPPED with each other as a trap — don't assume the more 'obvious-sounding' pairing is correct.

### MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "You'd better ring her \_\_\_\_ and tell her you'll be late."

- A. out
- B. in
- C. up ✓**
- D. without

*Explanation:* ring her up. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. "I invited her to drop \_\_\_\_ any time she was passing for a cup of tea."

- A. out
- B. in ✓**
- C. up
- D. without

*Explanation:* drop in. [medium, question-bank-2025]

3. "If you can't afford it, you'll have to do \_\_\_\_ it."

- A. out
- B. in
- C. up
- D. without ✓**

*Explanation:* do without it. [medium, question-bank-2025]

4. "He won't buy the car without trying it \_\_\_\_ on the road first."

- A. out ✓**
- B. in
- C. up

D. without

*Explanation:* trying it out. [medium, question-bank-2025]

5. What does the phrase "given to" mean?

A. Withdraw

**B. Accustomed to ✓**

C. Progress

D. Escape

*Explanation:* Accustomed to. [medium, question-bank-2022]

6. What does the phrase "cast down" mean?

A. Release

**B. Dejected ✓**

C. Continue

D. Appeal

*Explanation:* Dejected. [medium, question-bank-2022]

7. What does the phrase "reconcile to" mean?

A. Maintain

**B. Accept half-heartedly ✓**

C. Arrive suddenly

D. Continue

*Explanation:* Accept half-heartedly. [medium, question-bank-2024]

8. What does the idiom "to be at large" really mean?

A. To blame someone else

**B. Free / at liberty ✓**

C. To grow bigger

D. To shift responsibility

*Explanation:* Free / at liberty. [hard, question-bank-2025]

9. What does the idiom "to pass the buck" really mean?

A. Free / at liberty

**B. To shift blame/responsibility onto someone else ✓**

C. To spend money quickly

D. To win easily

*Explanation:* To shift blame/responsibility. [hard, question-bank-2025]

10. "Beauty lies in the eyes of the beholder" means:

A. Beauty is always objective and universal

**B. Beauty is subjective — it depends on who is looking ✓**

C. Only beautiful people can judge beauty

D. Beauty cannot be perceived by the eyes

*Explanation:* Beauty is subjective. [medium, question-bank-2024]